

Chicago Bears SWOT

Strengths

Historic Franchise

- The Chicago Bears are one of the NFL's original franchises with a long storied history. Legendary players have framed the Bears identity. This translates into a very high brand value, as the team is worth about \$8.2 billion and rising.

Large Market

- Chicago is the third largest media market behind New York and Los Angeles, and have a strong loyal fanbase. The organization excels at community outreach and marketing, such as their millions in annual donations to youth programs such as medical clinics and sports leagues.

Marketing and Social Media

- Innovative marketing efforts such as behind the scenes film, engaging with fans using polls/quizzes, and promoting fan content on their official social media pages.

Weaknesses

Outdated stadium and Capacity Limits

- Soldier Field is 101 years old and seats only 63,500, way too low for the Chicago market. This has resulted in the lowest attendance totals in the NFL despite the teams winning record and playoff berth.

High Ticket Prices

- Bears tickets averaged \$370 in 2025, among the most expensive in the NFL. High costs can price out the average fan and make them feel distant from their cities franchise.

New Stadium Complications

- Years of planning for an Arlington Heights stadium have created no legislative support, and fan reactions to potential development outside of Chicago and even Illinois continue to negatively affect the team's reputation.

Opportunities

New Stadium and Events

- A new domed stadium would not only raise seating capacity but would enable concerts and other year round events which would be extra revenue streams.

Global Outreach

- The NFL's international growth offers Chicago a chance to expand its fanbase to other countries, especially in the UK where the Bears have played multiple times.

Local Partnerships

- The continuation of community programs gives Chicago businesses access to a community in the bears and its fans, which strengthens the brand's reputation. These partnerships can be expanded in other areas like education and non-profits.

Threats

Fan Disengagement

- Continual stadium controversy and high ticket prices have frustrated fans and could lead to disengagement by fans. The only reason this hasn't happened on a large scale is because of the teams' recent success

Political and Legislative Issues

- The organization has failed to navigate Illinois legislation on the stadium project which could potentially leave the Bears without a long term plan and damage their local reputation.

Brand Risk From Relocation

- Even just the recent proposal of moving the team to Hammond, Indiana has enraged fans and made them feel unheard by the Bears organization. If this isn't sorted out soon this could be a serious brand threat.

Today the Bears are seen as a proud, traditional, blue-collar and defensive team with a loyal fanbase in a big market city. They publicly project values of community and loyalty, although performance struggles and stadium issues have given the Bears a frustrating reputation among fans. The image the Bears should be striving for is an international, world-class, but loyal and true to its roots, such as a European football club would be. They should continue to stay consistent with ideas of progressiveness and inclusivity, but do it on a global scale with programs like women's sports and community programs. The Bears want to be seen as Chicago's own beloved franchise while being on the front lines of fan engagement and outreach.